Ticketing Help Desk Project Log

Tools: Jira Service Management, Microsoft Entra ID | Author: Adel Nurhussein | Date: 10/16/26

1. Project Overview

I built a simulated help desk for a fictional company. I used Jira Service Management to manage requests and Microsoft Entra ID to carry out identity changes. I resolved five tickets covering the joiner/mover/leaver lifecycle, a password reset, and an approval-based access request, applying least privilege and separation of duties.

2. Environment

Fictional company name: Tesfa Financial

Number of users: 6 fictional employees, plus 1 admin account

Departments and groups: Departments: Sales, Finance, IT, HR. Security groups: Sales-Team, Finance-Team, IT-Team, HR-Team, Finance-Share-Access

Tools and versions/plans: Jira Service Management (Free), Microsoft Entra ID (Free)

3. Jira Setup

Request types

screenshot:

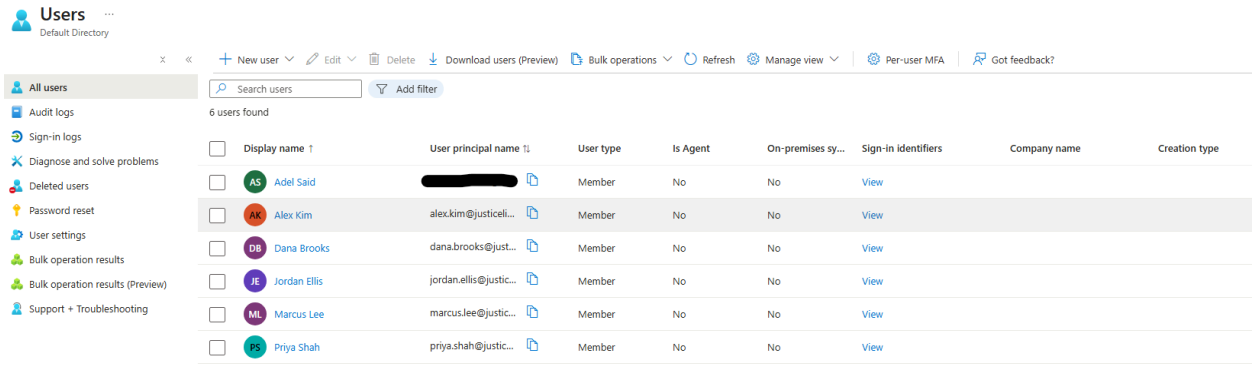
Request type	Work type	Workflow	Portal group	Restrictions	Actions
Access Request	[System] Service request ...	IT: Service Request Fulfilment with Approvals w...	Logins and Accou...		···
Onboard new employees	[System] Service request	IT: Service Request Fulfilment workflow for Jira...	Logins and Accou...		···
Password Reset	[System] Service request	IT: Service Request Fulfilment workflow for Jira...	Logins and Accou...		···
Role Change	[System] Service request	IT: Service Request Fulfilment workflow for Jira...	Logins and Accou...		···
Termination	[System] Service request	IT: Service Request Fulfilment workflow for Jira...	Logins and Accou...		···
Emailed request email channel	[System] Service request	IT: Service Request Fulfilment workflow for Jira...	Hidden from portal		···

Notes: Created Access Request (with approval workflow), Password Reset, Role Change, and Termination request types alongside the existing Onboard new employees type, all grouped under Logins and Accounts in the portal.

4. Entra Setup

4.1 Users

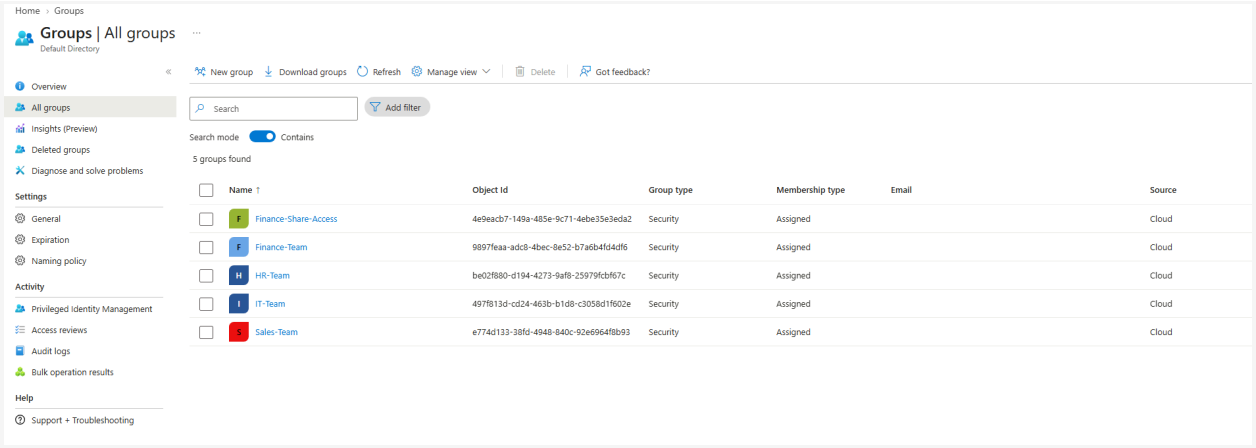
screenshot:



Notes: Which fake employees you created and their departments.

4.2 Groups

screenshot:



Notes: I created five fictional employees in Microsoft Entra ID before starting the tickets, each with a job title and department:

Priya Shah: Financial Analyst, Finance

Jordan Ellis: Accountant, Finance

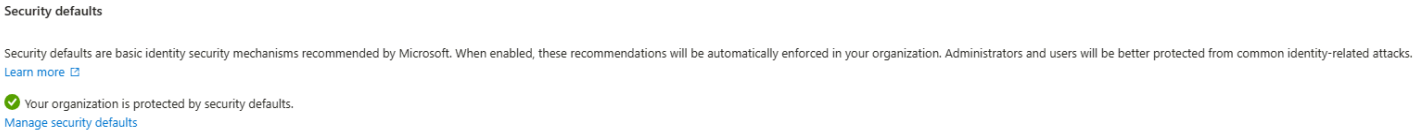
Marcus Lee: IT Support Technician, IT

Dana Brooks: HR Coordinator, HR

Alex Kim: Sales Manager, Sales

4.3 MFA / Security defaults

Paste screenshot:



Notes: Security defaults were already on for the tenant, requiring MFA registration for users. Setting reviewed and left enabled.

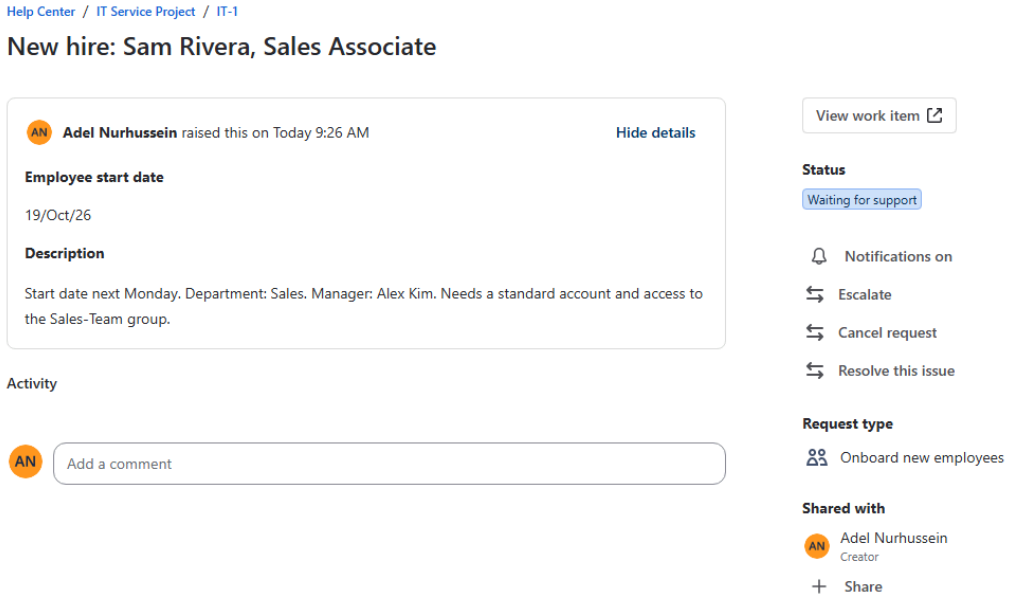
5. Tickets

Ticket 1: New Hire Onboarding (Joiner)

Requester: ___Adel Nurhussein ___ **Created:** _10/12/2026, 9:26 AM_

Request: Sam Rivera requesting onboarding access as a new hire.

Screenshot 1, ticket created:



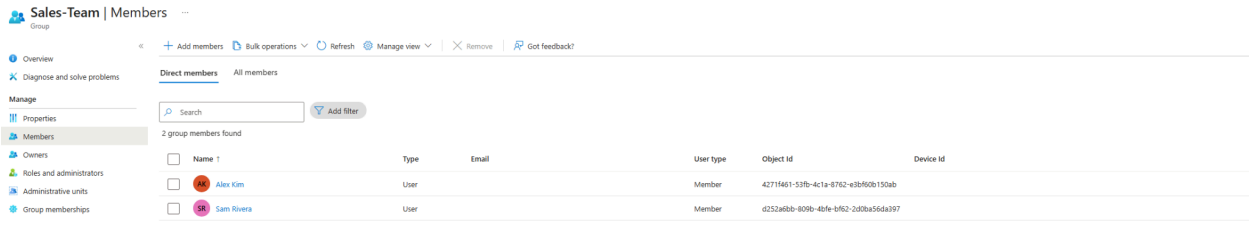
Steps taken in Entra:

1. Created user sam.rivera (Sam Rivera, Sales Associate, Sales) with an auto-generated temporary password.

2. Added Sam Rivera to the Sales-Team security group.

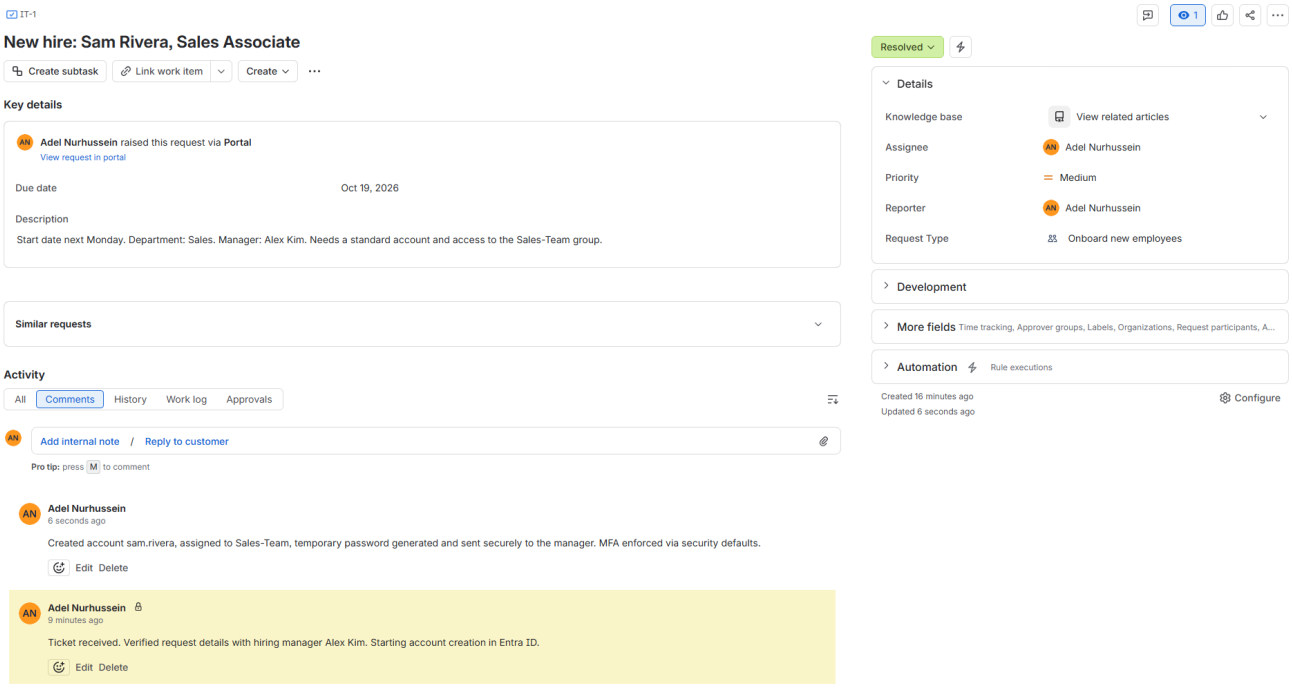
3. Confirmed MFA is enforced through security defaults.

Screenshot 2, action in Entra:



Resolution notes: Created account sam.rivera, assigned to Sales-Team, temporary password generated and sent securely to the manager. MFA enforced via security defaults.

Screenshot 3, ticket resolved:



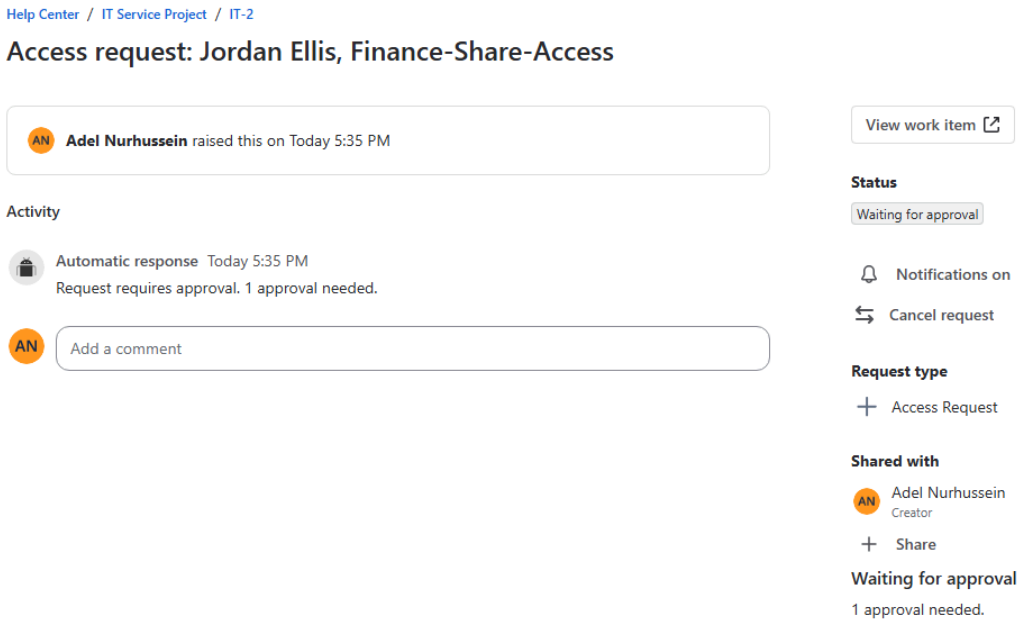
Concepts shown: Joiner process, role-based access control (RBAC), temporary password.

Ticket 2: Access Request (with approval)

Requester: __Adel Nurhussein(on behalf of Jordan Ellis) ____ **Approver:** ___Priya Sha (Finance Lead)___
Created: __10/16/2026 5:38pm____

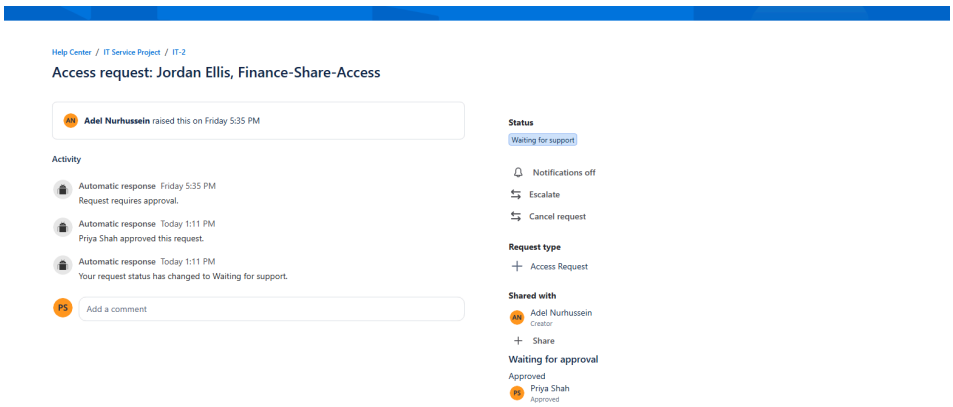
Request: Grant Jordan Ellis (Accountant) access to the finance shared resource (Finance-Share-Access group) to prepare month-end reports, subject to manager approval from Priya Shah.

Screenshot 1, ticket created:



`02-access-ticket-created.png`

Approval:

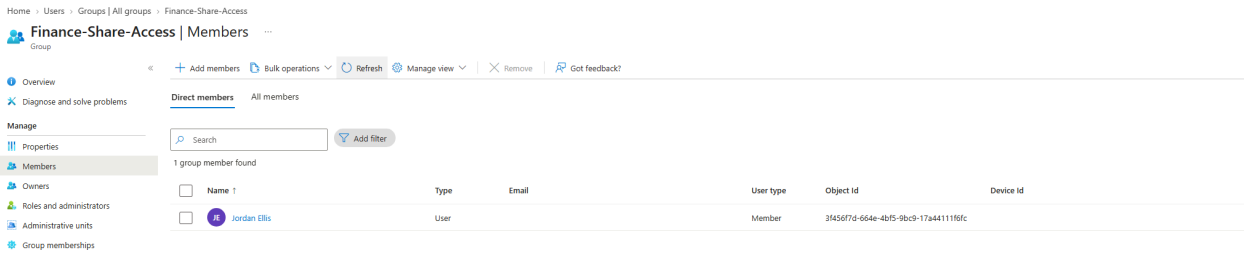


Steps taken in Entra:

1. Opened the Finance-Share-Access security group in Entra ID (Groups > All groups).

2. Added **Jordan Ellis** as a member (Members > Add members), after manager approval from Priya Shah was recorded in the ticket.

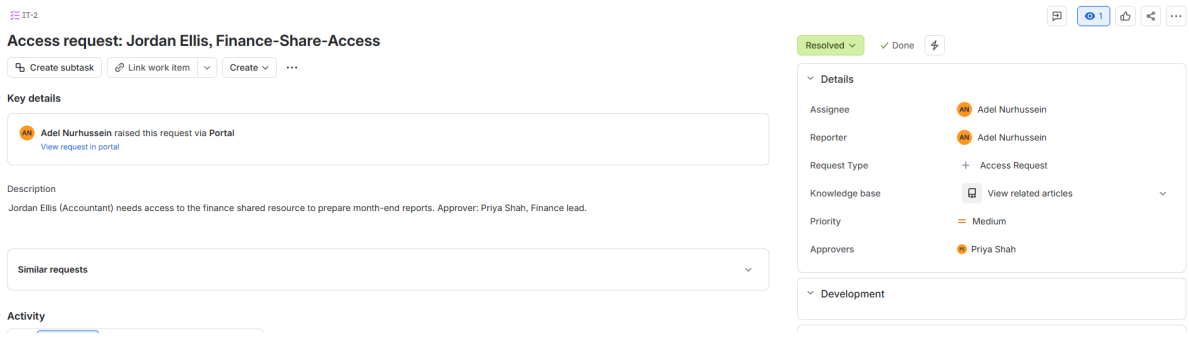
Screenshot 2, action in Entra:



`02-access-entra-action.png`

Resolution notes: ___Approval confirmed by Priya Shah. Adding user to the group in Entra.___

Screenshot 3, ticket resolved:



`02-access-resolved.png`

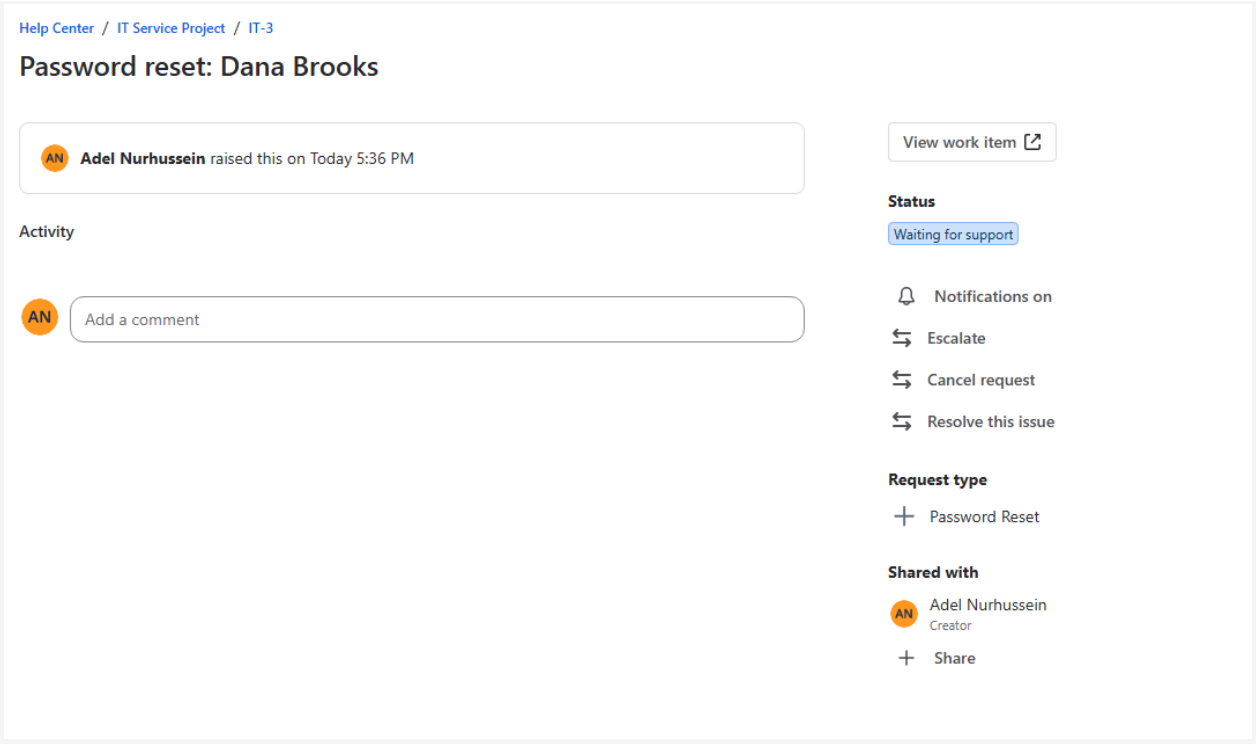
Concepts shown: Approval workflow, least privilege, group-based access.

Ticket 3: Password Reset

Requester: ____Dana Brooks (HR Coordinator)__ **Created:** __10_/18_/26 5:48pm_ **Resolved:** ___Yes___

Request: ___Dana Brooks (HR Coordinator) is locked out and needs a password reset. ___

Screenshot 1, ticket created:



03-password-ticket-created.png

Identity verification: How you confirmed the requester was who they said they were.

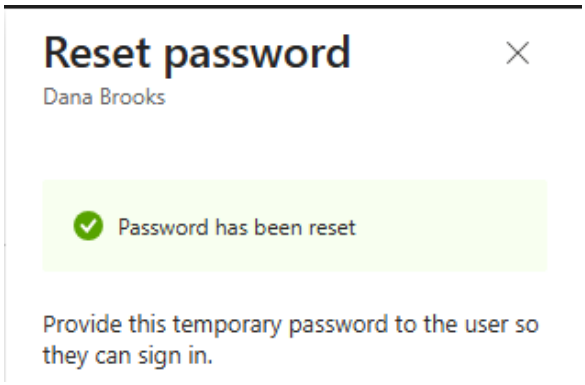
Steps taken in Entra:

1. Verified the requester's identity before the reset (confirmed with Dana's manager, Alex Kim, by phone).

2. Clicked Reset password and generated a temporary password.

3. Provided the temporary password through a secure channel. The user must change it at next sign-in.

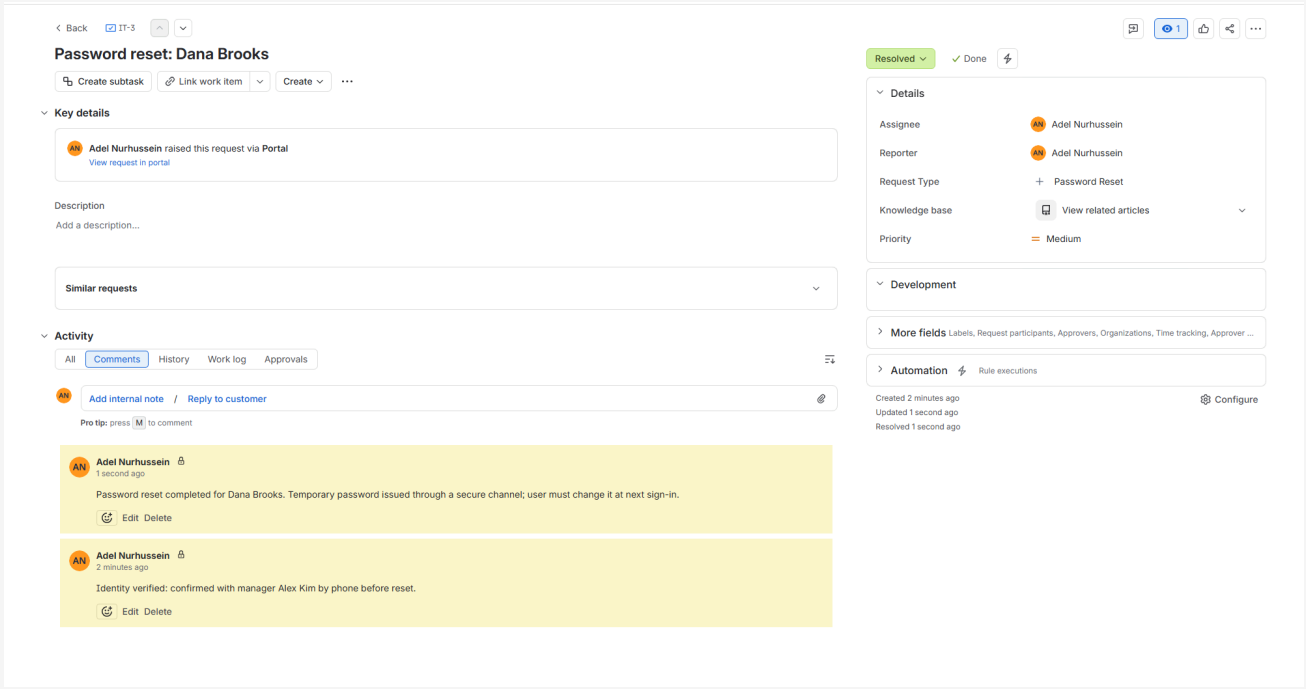
Screenshot 2, action in Entra:



`03-password-entra-action.png`

Resolution notes: ___Password reset completed for Dana Brooks. Identity verified with manager before the reset. Temporary password issued through a secure channel; user must change it at next sign-in.___

Screenshot 3, ticket resolved:



`03-password-resolved.png`

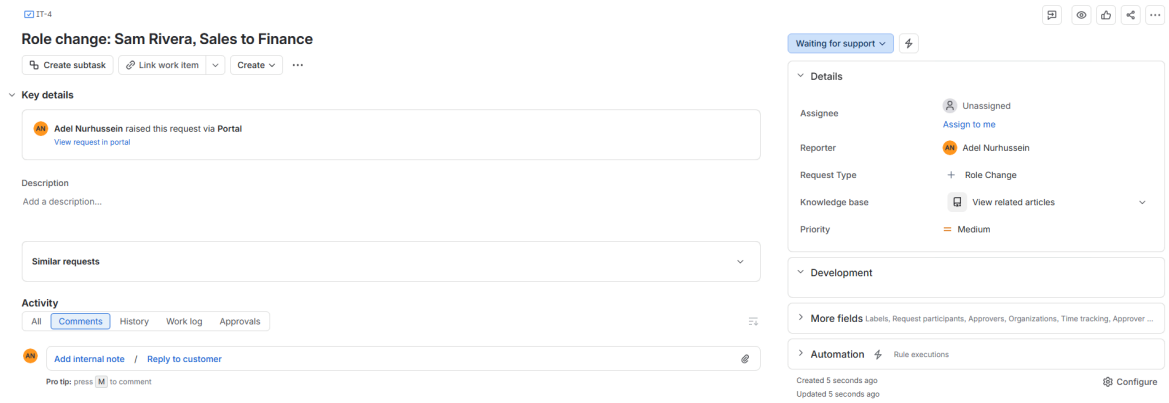
Concepts shown: Identity verification, secure credential handling, forced password change at next sign-in.

Ticket 4: Role Change (Mover)

Requester: ___Adel Nurhussein (on behalf of Sam Rivera)___ **Created:** ___10/19/26 9:32 am___

Request: Sam Rivera, who joined Sales in Ticket 1, transfers to the Finance department as a Financial Analyst. His Sales access has to come off, and Finance access goes on.

Screenshot 1, ticket created:

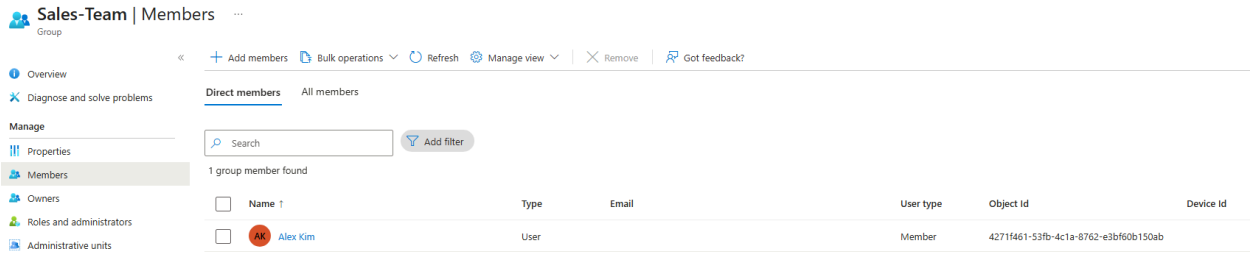


`04-role-change-ticket-created.png`

Access removed: __Sam's access from the Sales Group has been removed.____

Access added: __Sam has been granted access in the Finance Group.____

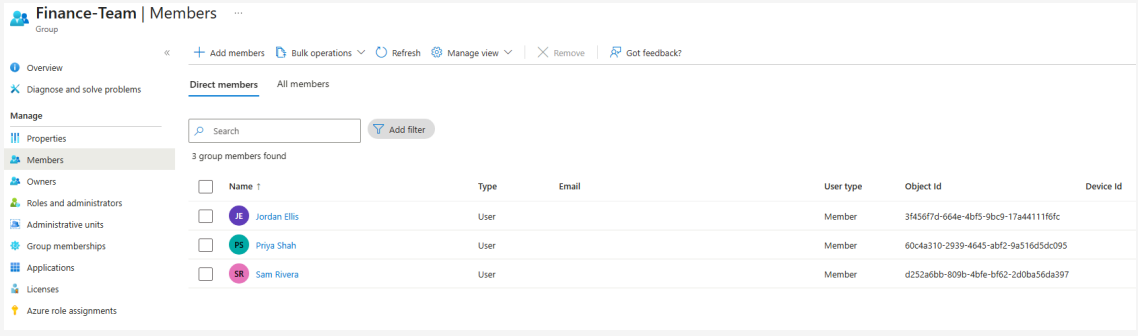
Screenshot 2, action in Entra:



`04-role-change-entra-action.png`

Resolution notes: _____

Screenshot 3, ticket resolved:



04-role-change-resolved.png

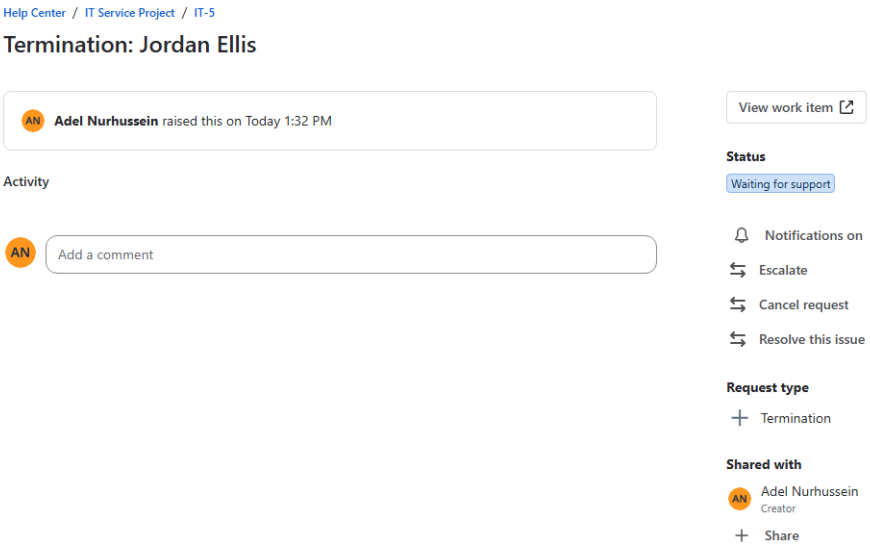
Concepts shown: Mover process, removing old access (least privilege), preventing privilege creep.

Ticket 5: Termination (Leaver)

Requester: __Adel Nurhussein(on behalf of Jordan Ellis)____ **Created:** __10/19/26 1:32pm__

Request: Disable the account of Jordan Ellis (Accountant, Finance), who is leaving the company, revoke active sessions, and remove all group memberships.

Screenshot 1, ticket created:

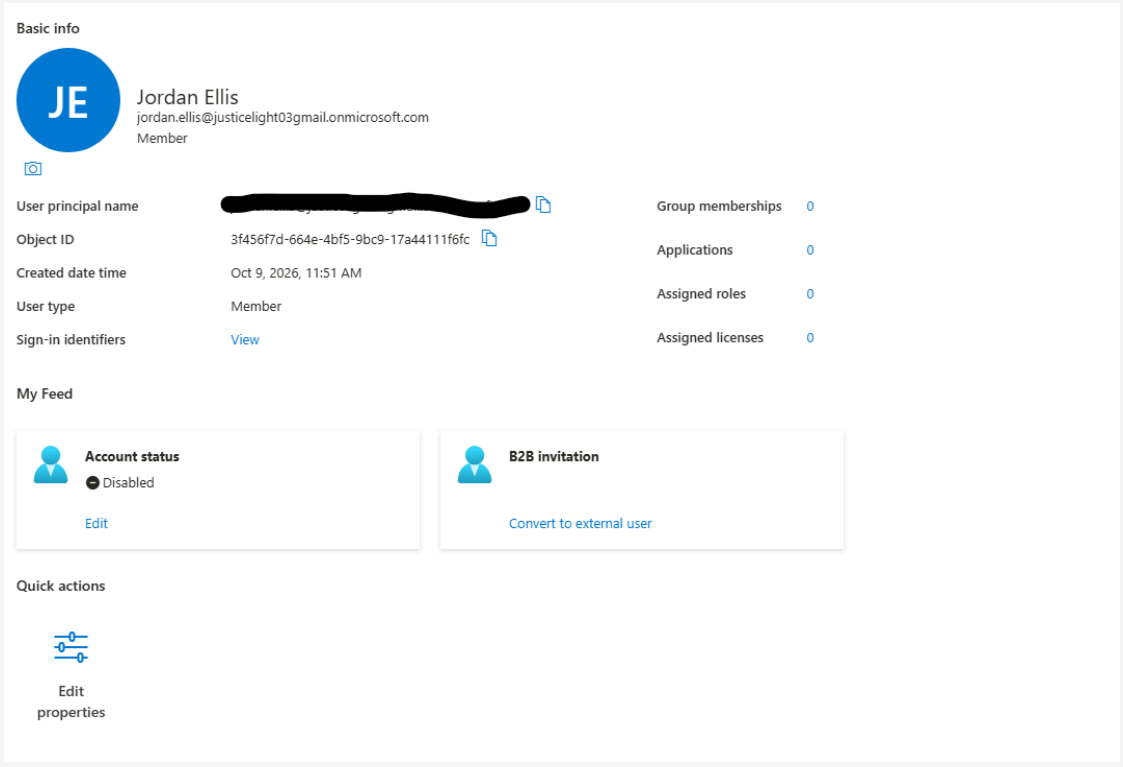


05-termination-ticket-created.png

Steps taken in Entra:

1. Revoked sessions
2. Removed group memberships
3. Disabled the account (Account enabled: off)
4. Logged the time of disablement in the ticket

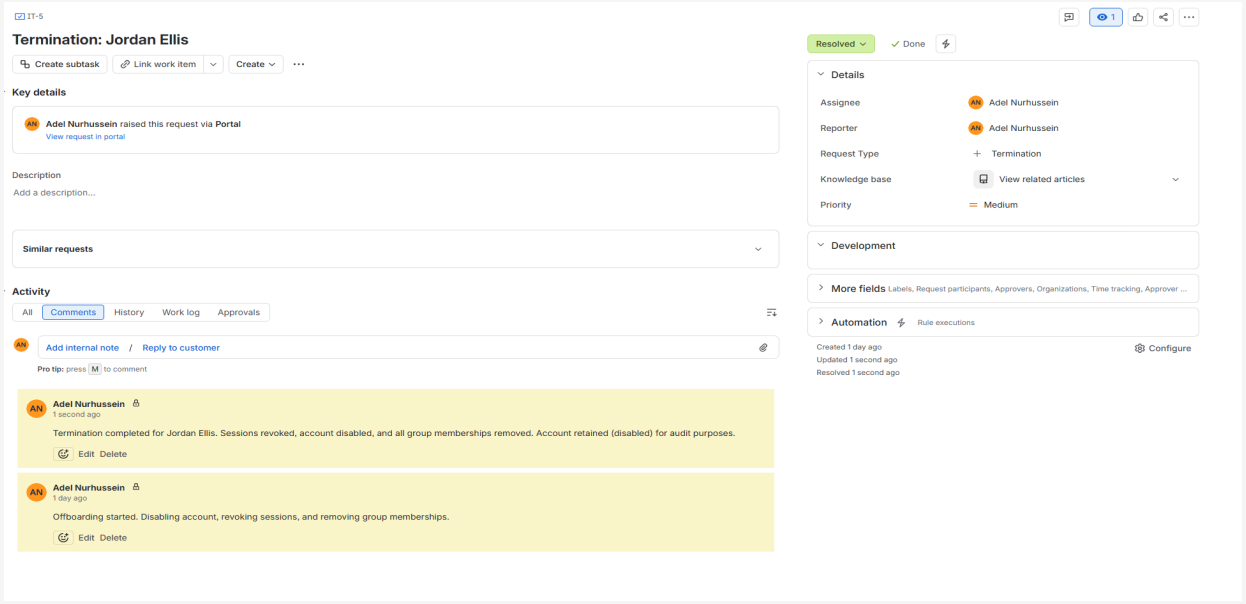
Screenshot 2, action in Entra:



05-termination-entra-action.png

Resolution notes: ___Now shows Jordan Ellis has no Group membership access to Finance Team or Finance Share Acess___

Screenshot 3, ticket resolved:



`05-termination-resolved.png`

Concepts shown: Leaver process, timely deprovisioning, audit trail.

6. Ticket Log

#	Ticket type	Request	Action taken	Time to resolve
1	Onboard new employees	New hire: Sam Rivera, Sales Associate	Created user in Entra, set job title and department, added to Sales-Team, temporary password generated	~10 min
2	Access Request	New hire: Sam Rivera, Sales Associate	Manager approval from Priya Shah recorded, then added Jordan Ellis to Finance-Share-Access	~16 min
3	Password Reset	Dana Brooks locked out of her account	Verified identity with manager, reset password in	~7 min

#	Ticket type	Request	Action taken	Time to resolve
			Entra, temporary password issued securely	
4	Role Change	Sam Rivera moving from Sales to Finance	Removed from Sales-Team, added to Finance-Team, updated job title and department	~9 min
5	Termination	Jordan Ellis leaving the company	Revoked sessions, disabled account, removed from Finance-Team and Finance-Share-Access, account retained for audit	~6 min

7. Runbooks

Write each as numbered steps another technician could follow.

Joiner (new hire)

1. Receive the onboarding ticket and confirm the employee's name, job title, department, manager, and start date.
2. Assign the ticket to yourself and set the status to In progress.
3. In Entra ID, go to Users > All users > New user > Create new user.
4. Enter the user principal name and display name, and leave Auto-generate password on.
5. On Properties, set the Job title and Department.
6. On Assignments, add the user to their department security group (for example, Sales-Team).
7. Click Review + create, then Create.
8. Send the temporary password to the manager through a secure channel. Never put it in the ticket.
9. Add resolution notes to the ticket and set the status to Resolved.

Mover (role change)

1. Receive the role change ticket and confirm the old department, the new department, and the effective date.
2. Assign the ticket to yourself and set the status to In progress.
3. In Entra ID, open the old department group (for example, Sales-Team) and go to Members.
4. Select the user and click Remove.
5. Open the new department group (for example, Finance-Team), go to Members, and click Add members.
6. Search for the user, click Select, and confirm they appear in the member list.
7. Update the user's Job title and Department under Edit properties.
8. Confirm the old access is gone, which prevents privilege creep.
9. Add resolution notes to the ticket and set the status to Resolved.

Leaver (termination)

1. Receive the termination ticket and confirm the employee, the last day, and who requested it.
2. Assign the ticket to yourself and set the status to In progress.
3. In Entra ID, open the user and click Revoke sessions to sign them out everywhere.
4. Click Edit properties, open Settings, turn Account enabled off, and click Save.
5. Open the user's Groups and remove every group membership (for example, Finance-Team and Finance-Share-Access).
6. Refresh the user's overview and confirm the account shows Disabled and Group memberships: 0.
7. Do not delete the account. Keep it disabled for audit purposes.
8. Add resolution notes with the time of disablement and set the status to Resolved.

Password reset

1. Receive the ticket and note who is locked out.
2. Verify the requester's identity before touching the account (for example, a callback to the user's manager). Don't reset a password on the strength of the ticket alone.
3. Record the verification in an internal note on the ticket.
4. Assign the ticket to yourself and set the status to In progress.

5. In Entra ID, go to Users > All users, open the user, and click Reset password.
6. Confirm the reset and copy the temporary password. Don’t write it in the ticket.
7. Give the temporary password to the user through a secure channel, and tell them to change it at next sign-in.
8. Add resolution notes and set the status to Resolved.

Access request

1. Receive the access request ticket and confirm who needs access, to which resource, and why.
2. Check that a manager's approval is recorded in the ticket. The requester cannot approve their own request.
3. Wait for the approver to click Approve in the Approvals panel. The status moves to Waiting for support.
4. Assign the ticket to yourself and set the status to In progress.
5. In Entra ID, open the resource’s security group (for example, Finance-Share-Access), go to Members, and click Add members.
6. Search for the user, click Select, and confirm they appear in the member list.
7. Grant only the access requested (least privilege).
8. Add resolution notes and set the status to Resolved.

8. Concepts Demonstrated

- Joiner/Mover/Leaver lifecycle
- Least privilege
- Role-based access control (RBAC)
- MFA via security defaults
- Approval workflow
- Identity verification
- Audit trail and SLA tracking

9. What I Learned

The hardest part was setting up the approval workflow for the access request. Jira would not let me approve my own ticket, which showed me how separation of duties is enforced in practice, so I had to create a second account to act as the approver. Getting that account working took several attempts: my first invite went to a misspelled email, the account started as a portal-only customer instead of an agent, and it needed to be added to the space before it could see the ticket. This taught me how Jira separates customer and agent roles, and that access has to be granted at both the site level and the space level. If I

repeated the project, I would create the approver account first and confirm its role and space access before raising the ticket. Next, I would like to rebuild the lab in ServiceNow and add an access review process.